

Chapter 4 – Metasploit Framework

Part 10 – Common Mistakes, Troubleshooting & Best Practices

Overview

This chapter summarizes common Metasploit issues, troubleshooting methodology, and professional best practices for authorized security assessments.

Troubleshooting Workflow

Read the error message → Verify configuration → Check connectivity → Review module information → Test again → Document results.

Common Issues

show missing – Review required options.
show options – Verify configured values.
info MODULE – Read module documentation.
db_status – Verify database connectivity.
jobs / jobs -k ID – Review or stop background jobs.
workspace – Confirm the active project.

Professional Best Practices

Always work with authorization, create a new workspace for each engagement, keep logs and notes, collect only necessary evidence, minimize impact, and produce clear documentation.

Interview Highlights

Know the difference between exploits and payloads, understand Meterpreter conceptually, explain workspaces, auxiliary modules, and resource scripts.

Master Cheat Sheet

Key commands: msfconsole, help, search, info, use, show options, show payloads, set/setg, run, exploit, workspace, hosts, services, vulns, notes, creds, loot, db_status, db_import, resource, makerc, spool, jobs, exit.

Final Revision

Metasploit is a framework supporting the full lifecycle of an authorized assessment. Strong organization, documentation, and reporting are as important as technical skills.